# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Monet Bags

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

## *Chief Financial Officer of the Meridian Museum*

Monet can locate a missing cent faster than anyone can locate the missing antiquity. Monet can tell you exactly how much tonight's floral installation cost, which donor paid for it, and which line item everyone is pretending it came from.

• Works with **Artie Ficial** and **Sue Venir** on museum budgets and donor agreements.

• Checks **Brie DeVivre**'s catering bills. **Brie** needs to explain every extra charge.

• **Elon Mosaic** keeps suggesting new museum technology. Monet keeps asking who will pay for it.

### ACTING TIPS

Quick, pragmatic, wry, unimpressed by grandeur for grandeur's sake. You notice costs other people pretend not to see. You're not afraid to spend money as long as it's a wise investment.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Monet Bags. I'm the CFO and I oversee the numbers. Please enjoy the gala, but know that any additional expenditures will not be reimbursed without a receipt.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

# Behind the portrait

## Your stake tonight

She grew up watching a parent wait for wages that did not arrive. Missing payroll is personal, not an abstract budget failure.

## During the investigation

Keep your account private until each round. Your printed answers establish what happened. You can react in your own style, but do not invent a new event, witness, or alibi.

## Conversations to start

- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page.
- Keep your private branch readings for their announced rounds.

*One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.*

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *The object that borrows your face has something above its reflection.*

2 *The painted world draws your gaze. The clue prefers its hidden reverse.*

3 *A soft cushion in the color of a clear sky conceals something behind it.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

### Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

### Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

### Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

### Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

### Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

### Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

# Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Friday. That's when wages are due. My mother used to wait by the phone on payday. I know what that does to a household. Grant's check could cover our staff; his terms let him question every transfer. Artie hated losing authority. I needed an amount I could put through payroll. Everyone kept saying rescue. Nobody gave me a date for the money.

## IF MURDERER

> Friday. That's when wages are due. My mother used to wait by the phone on payday. I know what that does to a household. I'd moved money to pay our staff. Grant wanted the books before releasing his check, and the board wanted answers too. Artie hated losing authority. I had transfers to explain and no time left to explain them.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

# Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> The manager brought the extra-course ticket to accounts. I crossed out our account and sent the donor copy back with the manager. Grant could sign for his cheese. I'd already moved restricted money into payroll without telling the board. Brie, I know the supplier wants paying. So do the cleaners. I had run out of people I could ask to wait.

## IF MURDERER

> The manager brought the cheese ticket to accounts. I crossed out our account and sent the donor copy back. The restricted-fund transfer was still off the board's agenda. Grant wanted my books before releasing his donation. I went to his private place to get a signature; his glass was waiting, he wasn't. I stayed with the unsigned bill for a bit. Brie, whose money did he think kept appearing whenever he asked for something? Mine? Yours?

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

# Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I sent the manager these instructions: serve the original order; bill the addition to Grant. The toast stayed booked. The restricted money paid staff wages. Yes, I moved it. Artie, don't tell them we all agreed. We didn't. I did it, and now a man is dead and I still catch myself calculating whether Friday is covered.

## IF MURDERER

I looked for Grant before the preview. His glass was set out, unwrapped, beside the invoice. He wasn't there. I left his copy for signing and returned to accounts. The cheese argument continued later. So did payroll. Artie, don't tell them we all agreed. We didn't. I was the one expected to find the money.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

STOP

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# Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## Your character name

## I accuse

## Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

# The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. My ticket went back through the manager; the paid toast continued. The restricted money went to wages. That doesn't authorize what I did. The board will have the whole account. I want someone to tell the staff before they read about it. They shouldn't spend tomorrow wondering whether their next paycheck is another promise from somebody in this room.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The accounts argument happened, and I sent the ticket back with the manager. My separate visit to find Grant was after the preview, while his unwrapped glass was waiting. I used poison I'd taken from the bottle. I told you that visit was before the preview; the manager had not even set out the glass then. I had already used restricted money for payroll. Grant wanted to examine the books and control the rescue. The wages were paid. That is the small fact I kept hiding behind. A family is waiting for a man who will never come home, and I made that happen.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*